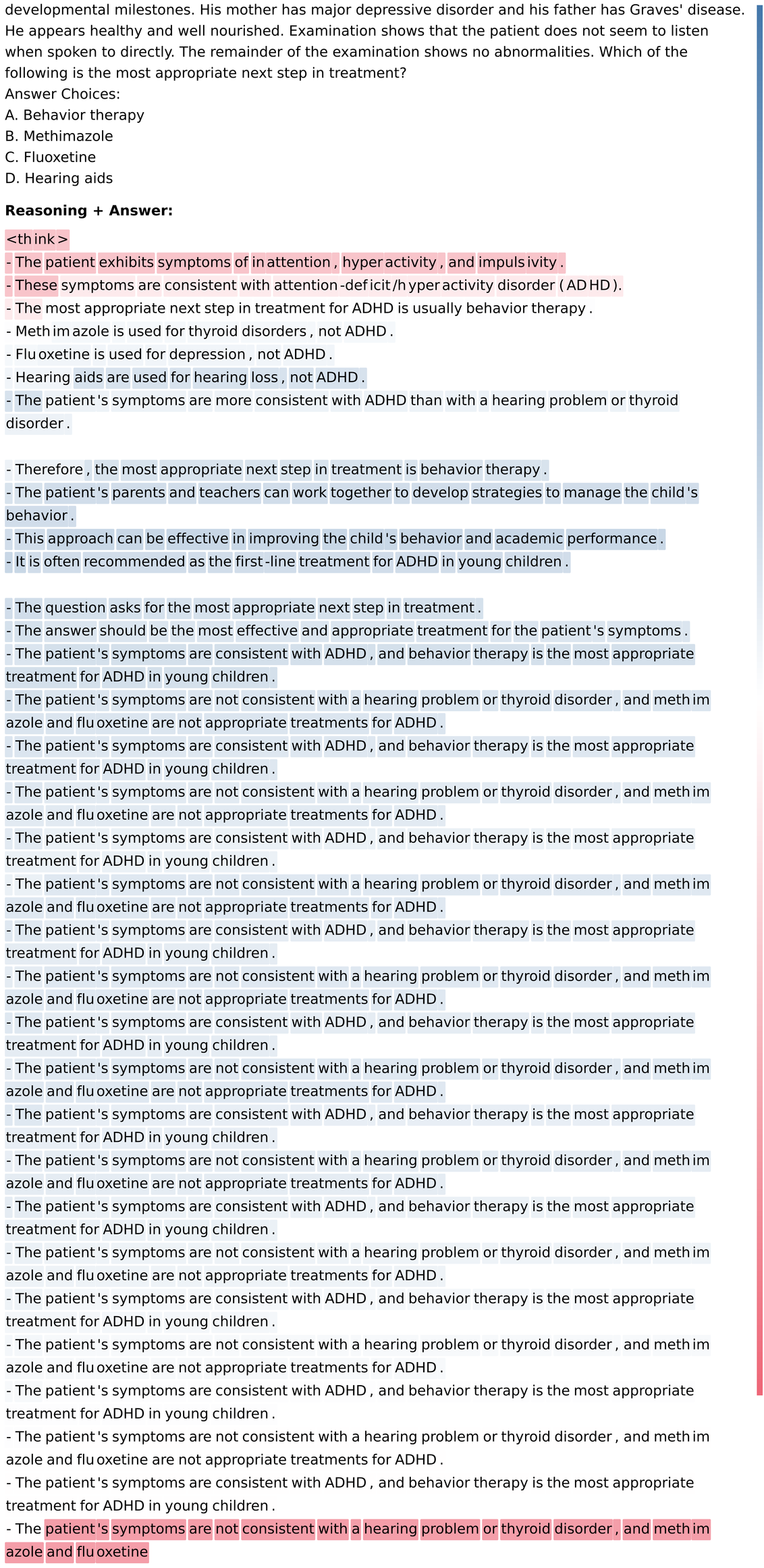
Question:
A 5-year-old boy is brought to the physician by his mother because he does not “listen to her” anymore. The mother also reports that her son cannot concentrate on any tasks lasting longer than just a few minutes. Teachers at his preschool report that the patient is more active compared to other preschoolers, frequently interrupts or bothers other children, and is very forgetful. Last year the patient was expelled from another preschool for hitting his teacher and his classmates when he did not get what he wanted and for being disruptive during classes. He was born at term via vaginal delivery and has been healthy except for 3 episodes of acute otitis media at the age of 2 years. He has met all developmental milestones. His mother has major depressive disorder and his father has Graves' disease. He appears healthy and well nourished. Examination shows that the patient does not seem to listen when spoken to directly. The remainder of the examination shows no abnormalities. Which of the following is the most appropriate next step in treatment?
Answer Choices:
A. Behavior therapy
B. Methimazole
C. Fluoxetine
D. Hearing aids

Reasoning + Answer:



<think>
- The patient exhibits symptoms of inattention, hyperactivity, and impulsivity.
- These symptoms are consistent with attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder (ADHD).
- The most appropriate next step in treatment for ADHD is usually behavior therapy.
- Methimazole is used for thyroid disorders, not ADHD.
- Fluoxetine is used for depression, not ADHD.
- Hearing aids are used for hearing loss, not ADHD.
- The patient's symptoms are more consistent with ADHD than with a hearing problem or thyroid disorder.

- Therefore, the most appropriate next step in treatment is behavior therapy.
- The patient's parents and teachers can work together to develop strategies to manage the child's behavior.
- This approach can be effective in improving the child's behavior and academic performance.
- It is often recommended as the first-line treatment for ADHD in young children.

- The question asks for the most appropriate next step in treatment.
- The answer should be the most effective and appropriate treatment for the patient's symptoms.
- The patient's symptoms are consistent with ADHD, and behavior therapy is the most appropriate treatment for ADHD in young children.
- The patient's symptoms are not consistent with a hearing problem or thyroid disorder, and methimazole and fluoxetine are not appropriate treatments for ADHD